

Applied philosophy



Questions of moral philosophy, and decisions of right and wrong, are a fundamental part of what happens in the courtroom.

In the face of ever-more successful and comprehensive scientific explanations of the world, the fields of metaphysics and epistemology have gradually received less attention from philosophers. The emphasis in late 20th-century philosophy shifted to moral philosophy and ethics, and especially political philosophy. Another recent change has been in the role that philosophy plays in society. For much of its history, Western philosophy has been the realm of the intelligentsia, viewed as an ‘ivory-

tower' academic discipline even in the modern era, but today the relevance of moral philosophy in particular has been recognized. Practical applications of philosophical ideas have been found not only in politics and the law, but also in business, economics, science and medicine, especially in the ethics of decision-making in those areas. Logic, too, has its place in analysing the validity of arguments in many spheres of life. Philosophers today are not only found in university departments, but also employed for their expertise by governments, health authorities and corporations.